SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

13 July 2022 · Shift 3

63 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 37 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The pirates will try to _____ the gold ornaments.

(A) cease
(B) seize
(C) slice
(D) steel

Q.2

Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words. One who collects coins

(A) Bibliophile
(B) Enthusiast
(C) Philatelist
(D) Numismatist

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. I may sound crazy but I am not an “imbecile.”

(A) Credible
(B) Prudent
(C) Dunce
(D) Sage

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Rescuers used a special device for finding people _____ in collapsed buildings.

(A) conquered
(B) trapped
(C) exceeded
(D) blossomed

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. If nature _____ to degrade, the world’s economic output will suffer sooner or later.

(A) Continues
(B) Continue
(C) Continued
(D) continuing

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. He pays me six dollars “the month of this” house.

(A) No improvement required
(B) an month for these
(C) a month over this
(D) a month for this

Q.7

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Fatal

(A) Luminous
(B) Restorative
(C) Serene
(D) Deadly

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word from the given sentence. He leaned left, bringing the “blunt” side of his sword up flat against his palm.

(A) sharp
(B) dull
(C) timid
(D) keen

Q.9

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Accede
(B) Accost
(C) Abstruce
(D) Abnegation

Q.10

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A large bundle bound for storage or transport

(A) Antagonist
(B) Belligerent
(C) Bale
(D) Apiary

Q.11

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. She was stuck in “his imagination for many a hour as a force” to be reckoned with.

(A) his imagination for many hour as a force
(B) his imagination for many an hour as a force
(C) his imagination for many an hours as a force
(D) No improvement required

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. Does my name “ring a bell” for you?

(A) To sound familiar
(B) To be very frightened
(C) To take advantage
(D) To mock someone

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required.’ The laws of nature “are unbiased,” ensuring that each person benefits from its bounties.

(A) No substitution required
(B) were unbiased
(C) is unbiased
(D) was unbiased

Q.14

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. How the students approach / education today has / altered significant.

(A) altered significant
(B) education today has
(C) No error
(D) How the students approach

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Kick someone when they are down

(A) To create a disturbance deliberately
(B) To reject or disown friends
(C) To be angry with or disappointed in someone
(D) To cause further trouble to someone already in a difficult situation

Q.16

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Definitely
(B) Definately
(C) Defenately
(D) Difinately

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I am planning a get together _____ Monday.

(A) at
(B) upon
(C) along
(D) on

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Vicious

(A) Influential
(B) Gentle
(C) Privileged
(D) Poor

Q.20

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. I like reading fictional stories besides write poems.

(A) No error
(B) fictional stories besides
(C) write poems
(D) I like reading

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. No matter how (1) _____ time you (2) _____ to improve your mental and emotional health, you will still need the company of (3) _____ to feel and function at your best. Humans are social (4) _____ with emotional needs for relationships and positive connections to others. We're not meant to survive, (5) _____ alone thrive, in isolation.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. (1)

(A) many
(B) great
(C) more
(D) much

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. No matter how (1) _____ time you (2) _____ to improve your mental and emotional health, you will still need the company of (3) _____ to feel and function at your best. Humans are social (4) _____ with emotional needs for relationships and positive connections to others. We're not meant to survive, (5) _____ alone thrive, in isolation.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. (2)

(A) devote
(B) promote
(C) assess
(D) proceed

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. No matter how (1) _____ time you (2) _____ to improve your mental and emotional health, you will still need the company of (3) _____ to feel and function at your best. Humans are social (4) _____ with emotional needs for relationships and positive connections to others. We're not meant to survive, (5) _____ alone thrive, in isolation.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. (3)

(A) some
(B) any
(C) others
(D) few

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. No matter how (1) _____ time you (2) _____ to improve your mental and emotional health, you will still need the company of (3) _____ to feel and function at your best. Humans are social (4) _____ with emotional needs for relationships and positive connections to others. We're not meant to survive, (5) _____ alone thrive, in isolation.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. (4)

(A) kingdoms
(B) populations
(C) creatures
(D) lives

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. No matter how (1) _____ time you (2) _____ to improve your mental and emotional health, you will still need the company of (3) _____ to feel and function at your best. Humans are social (4) _____ with emotional needs for relationships and positive connections to others. We're not meant to survive, (5) _____ alone thrive, in isolation.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. (5)

(A) have
(B) lest
(C) let
(D) get

General Intelligence and Reasoning 17 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, 'GOAL' is coded as '917314', and 'PBKS' is coded as '1841321'. How will 'HAMD' be coded in that language?

(A) 101356
(B) 101365
(C) 103165
(D) 103156

Q.2

After interchanging the given two signs × and –, what will be the value of the given expression? 10 + 5 – 6 ÷ 2 × 5

(A) 30
(B) 35
(C) 20
(D) 25

Q.3

In a certain code language, 'he is sick' is written as 'blue red pink', 'he wants apple' is written as 'green violet red', and 'apple is tasty' is written as 'blue green yellow'. How will 'tasty' be written in that language?

(A) Violet
(B) Blue
(C) Yellow
(D) Pink

Q.5

Which two numbers need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 22 – 9 ÷ 5 + 10 × 1 = 29

(A) 22 and 10
(B) 5 and 1
(C) 10 and 9
(D) 5 and 10

Q.9

Select the number from the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 137, 125, 113, 101, ?

(A) 87
(B) 84
(C) 86
(D) 89

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. ABC2 : ZYX7 :: PQR21 : KJI26 :: MNO11 : ?

(A) NML16
(B) KLM14
(C) NLM14
(D) MKL16

Q.12

Four girls A, B, C, and D are sitting in a row, facing towards the south (but not necessarily in the same order). Four boys P, Q, R and S are sitting in a row, facing towards the face of these girls (but not necessarily in the same order). P and C are diagonally opposite to each other. A is second to the right of C. S is the immediate neighbour of Q and R. C is facing R. Which of the following pairs of persons facing each other is definitely correct?

(A) DP
(B) BS
(C) AQ
(D) DS

Q.13

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. AY, BX, ?, DV, EU, FT

(A) CV
(B) CW
(C) CE
(D) CU

Q.14

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 347 : 14 :: 122 : 5 :: 244 : ?

(A) 12
(B) 10
(C) 8
(D) 14

Q.15

Identify the number that does NOT belong to the following series. 414, 430, 462, 526, 664, 910

(A) 462
(B) 526
(C) 910
(D) 664

Q.18

In a certain code language, ‘Heat is waves’ is coded as ‘7 6 @’, and ‘waves are dramatic not’ is coded as ‘3 4 % 7’. What can be the code for ‘Heat’ in that language?

(A) %
(B) 4
(C) @
(D) 3

Q.19

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. GP : KK :: MN : ?

(A) QI
(B) QJ
(C) RI
(D) RJ

Q.20

Five professors A, B, C, D and E are sitting in a row facing the North (not necessarily in the same order). A is second to the left of D. Only two professors are sitting between C and E. No professor is sitting to the right of E. How many professors are sitting to the left of D?

(A) 3
(B) 0
(C) 2
(D) 1

Q.21

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (8, 12, 48); (6, 18, 54)

(A) (6, 12, 48)
(B) (4, 8, 12)
(C) (6, 8, 30)
(D) (4, 8, 16)

Q.23

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. No R is S. II. All X are R. Conclusions: I. Some R are X. II. Some S are X. III. All X are S.

(A) Only conclusion III follows
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) None of the conclusions follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.24

In a certain code language, '321' means 'hot branded milk', '653' means 'nice hot day', '985' means 'day and night', then what is the code for 'nice' in the same code language?

(A) 9
(B) 3
(C) 5
(D) 6

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PRA : SUZ :: GOS : ?

(A) JRU
(B) JSU
(C) JRH
(D) JSH

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) is regulated by _____.

(A) Indian Bank
(B) Reserve Bank of India
(C) ICICI Bank
(D) State Bank of India

Q.3

As per the Preamble of the Constitution of India, India is a/an _____.

(A) oligarchy
(B) monarchy
(C) republic
(D) aristocracy

Q.4

Which of the following universities was founded by Kumaragupta, the ruler of the Gupta dynasty?

(A) Delhi University
(B) Nalanda University
(C) Pune University
(D) Taxila University

Q.5

Manika Batra is associated with which sport?

(A) Wrestling
(B) Badminton
(C) Boxing
(D) Table Tennis

Q.6

According to the Constitution of India, there shall be a Comptroller and Auditor General of India who shall be appointed by the _____.

(A) Prime Minister of India
(B) Attorney General of India
(C) President of India
(D) Chief Justice of India

Q.7

Khajuraho temple in Madhya Pradesh is an example of _____ style of temple architecture.

(A) Dravida
(B) Vesara
(C) Nagara
(D) Hoysala

Q.8

When a cell divides by meiosis it produces _____ new cells.

(A) 4
(B) 2
(C) 3
(D) 5

Q.10

The Inland Vessels Bill, 2021 is associated with the Ministry of _____.

(A) Jal Shakti
(B) Civil Aviation
(C) Home Affairs
(D) Ports, Shipping and Waterways

Q.11

What was the original name of Swami Vivekananda?

(A) Mula Sankara
(B) Narendranath Dutta
(C) Vardhamana
(D) Nrusimha Bhan

Q.12

Limestone, chalk and marble are different forms of _____.

(A) calcium carbonate
(B) sodium carbonate
(C) potassium carbonate
(D) magnesium carbonate

Q.13

Which TMC candidate won the Ballygunge (West Bengal) by-poll election in April 2022?

(A) Babul Supriyo
(B) Amit Shah
(C) Mamata Banerjee
(D) Derek O'Brien

Q.14

Which of the following states has the highest reserves of haematite ore in India?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Odisha

Q.15

Alarmel Valli is associated with which classical dance of India?

(A) Manipuri
(B) Sattriya
(C) Kathak
(D) Bharatanatyam

Q.16

'Wings of Fire' is a famous autobiography of which Indian scientist?

(A) Homi J Bhabha
(B) CV Raman
(C) APJ Abdul Kalam
(D) Vikram Sarabhai

Q.17

In its longitudinal extent, the Himalaya consists of _____ parallel ranges.

(A) three
(B) five
(C) four
(D) two

Q.18

Pulakesin I was the founder of _____ dynasty of South India.

(A) Chera
(B) Pandya
(C) Chalukya
(D) Chola

Q.19

Which of the following cell organelles help to keep the cell clean by digesting any foreign material as well as worn-out cell organelles?

(A) Mitochondria
(B) Ribosome
(C) Lysosome
(D) Vacuole

Q.20

Who among the following is a famous tennis player?

(A) Neeraj Chopra
(B) Milkha Singh
(C) Mahesh Bhupathi
(D) TC Yohannan

Q.21

The number of live births per thousand persons in a year is called _____.

(A) growth rate
(B) fertility rate
(C) death rate
(D) birth rate

Q.23

MS Subbulakshmi was a famous _____ singer of India.

(A) Jazz
(B) Carnatic
(C) Hiphop
(D) Rock

Q.24

Mangal Pandey was hanged to death for attacking British officers in Barrackpore on _____.

(A) 21 March 1857
(B) 23 March 1857
(C) 31 March 1857
(D) 29 March 1857

Q.25

Pandit Birju Maharaj who passed away in January 2022 was related with which classical dance of India?

(A) Bharatanatyam
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Sattriya
(D) Kathak

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**
Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**
Q.21 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**		

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (B) seize

To 'seize' is to take hold of something by force, as pirates would the gold. 'Cease' means to stop.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Numismatist

A numismatist collects or studies coins. A philatelist collects stamps and a bibliophile loves books.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Dunce

An 'imbecile' is a stupid person, and so is a 'dunce'. A 'sage' is a wise person, 'prudent' means wise and 'credible' believable.

Q.4 · Answer (B) trapped

People 'trapped' in collapsed buildings are caught there and cannot get out, so rescuers must find them.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Continues

In a first conditional the 'if' clause takes the simple present, and the singular 'nature' takes 'continues': 'If nature continues to degrade, ...'

Q.6 · Answer (D) a month for this

A rate per period takes 'a' ('six dollars a month'), and the payment is 'for' the house: 'He pays me six dollars a month for this house.'

Q.7 · Answer (D) Deadly

'Fatal' means causing death: 'deadly'. 'Restorative' means healing, nearly the opposite.

Q.8 · Answer (B) dull

A 'blunt' edge is not sharp: 'dull'. 'Sharp' and 'keen' are its opposites.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Abstruce

'Abstruce' is misspelt: the word is 'abstruse', meaning hard to understand.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Bale

A bale is a large bundle of goods, such as cotton or hay, bound for storage or transport. An apiary is a place where bees are kept.

Q.11 · Answer (B) his imagination for many an hour as a force

'Many a' takes a singular noun, and 'hour' begins with a vowel sound, so it is 'many an hour'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) To sound familiar

If something 'rings a bell', it sounds familiar: the speaker asks whether the name reminds the listener of anything.

Q.13 · Answer (A) No substitution required

The plural subject 'laws' takes 'are', and the present tense fits 'ensuring that each person benefits', so the sentence is correct as it stands.

Q.14 · Answer (A) altered significant

The verb 'altered' must be modified by an adverb: 'has altered significantly'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) To cause further trouble to someone already in a difficult situation

To 'kick someone when they are down' is to make things worse for someone who is already in trouble.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Definitely

'Definitely' has 'finite' in the middle: de-finite-ly. The other three spell it with an 'a'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) on

Days and dates take 'on': 'a get together on Monday'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Gentle
'Vicious' means cruel or violent; its opposite is 'gentle'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) write poems
'Besides' is a preposition here, so the verb after it takes the '-ing' form: 'besides writing poems'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) much
'Time' is uncountable, so 'how much time'; 'many' goes with countable nouns.

Q.22 · Answer (A) devote
To 'devote' time to something is to spend it on that purpose. 'Promote', 'assess' and 'proceed' do not take 'time' in this sense.

Q.23 · Answer (C) others
'The company of others' means being with other people; 'some', 'any' and 'few' would each need a noun after them.

Q.24 · Answer (C) creatures
'Humans are social creatures': 'creatures' are living beings. 'Kingdoms', 'populations' and 'lives' cannot describe a human.

Q.25 · Answer (C) let
'Let alone' means 'still less': we are not meant even to survive in isolation, still less to thrive.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) 103156
Each letter is written as its place in the alphabet plus 2: G O A L → 9, 17, 3, 14 and P B K S → 18, 4, 13, 21. So H A M D → 10, 3, 15, 6: 103156.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 20
After interchanging the signs: 10 + 5 × 6 ÷ 2 – 5 = 10 + 15 – 5 = 20.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Yellow
'He' is in the first two sentences, so he = red; 'is' in the first and third, so is = blue; 'apple' in the second and third, so apple = green. The code left in 'apple is tasty' is yellow.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 10 and 9
Interchanging 10 and 9: 22 – 10 ÷ 5 + 9 × 1 = 22 – 2 + 9 = 29.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 89
Each term is 12 less than the one before: 101 – 12 = 89.

Q.10 · Answer (A) NML16
Each letter is replaced by its opposite (A↔Z, B↔Y, C↔X and so on) and 5 is added to the number: ABC2 → ZYX7 and PQR21 → KJI26. So MNO11 → NML16.

Q.12 · Answer (C) AQ
Number the places 1 to 4 from west to east; the girls face south, so their right is west. P and C, diagonally opposite, sit at opposite ends, and A second to the right of C puts C at 4 and A at 2. R faces C at 4, so P is at 1, and S, between Q and R, is at 3, leaving Q at 2, facing A. B and D could sit either way round, so only AQ is certain.

Q.13 · Answer (B) CW
The first letters run A, B, C, D, E, F and the second Y, X, W, V, U, T: CW.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 10
The second number is the sum of the digits of the first: 3 + 4 + 7 = 14 and 1 + 2 + 2 = 5. So 2 + 4 + 4 = 10.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 664
The differences double: 16, 32, 64, 128, 256. The fifth term should be 526 + 128 = 654, and 654 + 256 = 910; 664 does not fit.

Q.18 · Answer (C) @
'Waves' is in both sentences and 7 is the only code they share, so waves = 7. 'Heat' is then 6 or @, and of these only @ is offered.

Q.19 · Answer (A) QI
The first letter moves 4 forward and the second 5 back: G → K and P → K. So M → Q and N → I: QI.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 2
No one sits to the right of E, so E is at the right end (place 5) and C, with two between them, at place 2. A is second to the left of D, so A and D are at 1 and 3, and B at 4. Two professors, A and C, sit to the left of D.

Q.21 · Answer (D) (4, 8, 16)
The third number is half the product of the first two: 8 × 12 ÷ 2 = 48 and 6 × 18 ÷ 2 = 54. Likewise 4 × 8 ÷ 2 = 16.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Only conclusion I follows
All X are R, so some R are X: I follows. As no R is S and every X is an R, no X is S, so II and III are both false.

Q.24 · Answer (D) 6
'Hot' is in the first two sentences, whose common code is 3; 'day' is in the last two, whose common code is 5. In '653' (nice hot day) the code left for 'nice' is 6.

Q.25 · Answer (C) JRH
The first two letters move 3 forward and the third is replaced by its opposite letter: P → S, R → U and A → Z. So G → J, O → R and S → H: JRH.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Reserve Bank of India
SIDBI, set up in 1990 under its own Act to finance small industries, is an all-India financial institution regulated and supervised by the Reserve Bank of India.

Q.3 · Answer (C) republic
The Preamble declares India a sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic republic: its head of state is elected, not hereditary.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Nalanda University
Nalanda mahavihara in Bihar is credited to the Gupta ruler Kumaragupta I, in the 5th century CE. Taxila is far older, and the Delhi and Pune universities are modern.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Table Tennis
Manika Batra is an Indian table tennis player; she won the women's singles gold at the 2018 Commonwealth Games.

Q.6 · Answer (C) President of India
Under Article 148 the Comptroller and Auditor General of India is appointed by the President, by warrant under his hand and seal.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Nagara
Khajuraho's temples, built under the Chandela rulers, are in the northern Nagara style, with curved shikharas. Dravida is the southern style, and Vesara, of which Hoysala temples are a form, mixes the two.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 4
Meiosis has two divisions, so one cell gives four daughter cells, each with half the number of chromosomes.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Ports, Shipping and Waterways
The Inland Vessels Bill, 2021, brought by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways and passed by Parliament in July-August 2021, replaced the Inland Vessels Act, 1917 with one law for the whole country.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Narendranath Dutta
Swami Vivekananda was born Narendranath Datta in Calcutta in 1863. Mula Sankara (Mool Shankar) was Swami Dayananda Saraswati's name, and Vardhamana Mahavira's.

Q.12 · Answer (A) calcium carbonate
Limestone, chalk and marble are all forms of calcium carbonate ($CaCO_3$).

Q.13 · Answer (A) Babul Supriyo
Babul Supriyo won the Ballygunge Assembly by-poll for the Trinamool Congress; the result was declared on 16 April 2022. The seat had fallen vacant on the death of Subrata Mukherjee.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Odisha
The Indian Bureau of Mines puts the largest share of India's haematite reserves and resources in Odisha, ahead of Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and Karnataka.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Bharatanatyam
Alarmel Valli of Chennai is a Bharatanatyam dancer of the Pandanallur style.

Q.16 · Answer (C) APJ Abdul Kalam
'Wings of Fire' (1999), written with Arun Tiwari, is the autobiography of A P J Abdul Kalam, the missile scientist who later became President.

Q.17 · Answer (A) three
NCERT describes the Himalaya as three parallel ranges along its length: the Great or Inner Himalaya (Himadri), the Lesser Himalaya (Himachal) and the Shiwaliks.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Chalukya
Pulakesin I founded the Chalukya dynasty of Badami (Vatapi) in the 6th century CE, making Vatapi his capital.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Lysosome
Lysosomes are membrane sacs of digestive enzymes that break down foreign material and worn-out organelles, keeping the cell clean.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Mahesh Bhupathi
Mahesh Bhupathi is a tennis player, winner of several Grand Slam doubles and mixed doubles titles. Neeraj Chopra throws the javelin, Milkha Singh was a sprinter and T C Yohannan a long jumper.

Q.21 · Answer (D) birth rate
The birth rate is the number of live births per thousand people in a year; the death rate counts deaths the same way.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Carnatic
M S Subbulakshmi was a Carnatic vocalist, the first musician to receive the Bharat Ratna (1998).

Q.24 · Answer (D) 29 March 1857
Mangal Pandey of the 34th Bengal Native Infantry attacked British officers at Barrackpore on 29 March 1857, the date the blank asks for; he was hanged on 8 April 1857.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Kathak
Pandit Birju Maharaj was a Kathak dancer of the Lucknow (Kalka-Bindadin) gharana.

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